Slicing the Pie

Business Insights from Pizza Sales Data

Dec 2025 - Mar 2026

Performance Metrics (KPIs)

Introduction

A data analyst hired by a popular pizza restaurant chain, your task is to derive meaningful business insights from their historical sales data. The company aims to improve marketing strategies, manage inventory more efficiently, and make better operational decisions.

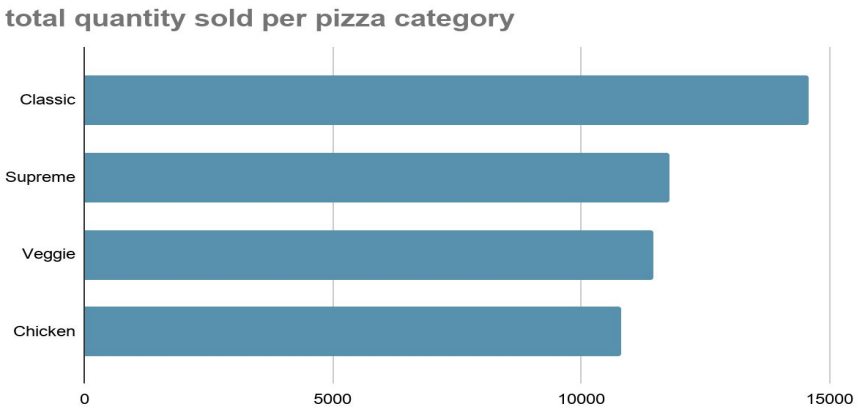
Financial overview

Total Revenue Generated: Approximately $817.86K - $817.9K.

Total Orders Placed: 21,350 to 48,620 (figures vary based on specific data subsets, with 48.62K representing the total line items/detailed records).

Average Order Value: 10701.48

Total Pizzas Sold: Approximately 49,574.



- Classic: Highest sales = 11,050
- Supreme: Second highest = 14,888
- Chicken: Third highest = 11,987
- Veggie: Lowest sales = 11,649

(Note: Classic category often contributes over 220K in revenue, indicating it is the most popular choice).

KEY INSIGHTS SUMMARY

Top sellers: The Classic Deluxe Pizza, Barbecue Chicken Pizza, and Pepperoni Pizza are top performers, while the Brie Carre Pizza is the lowest seller

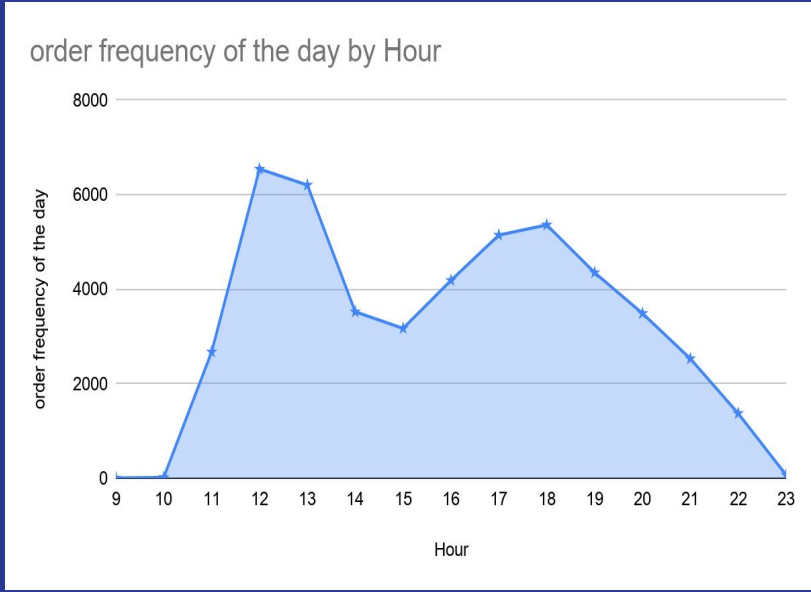
Best-Selling Size: Large (L) pizzas dominate with 46% of total sales.

Peak Activity: Fridays, Thursdays, and Saturdays hold the highest sales volume, with peak hours between 12:00 PM – 1:00 PM and 5:00 PM – 6:00 PM

Sales & Seasonal Trends

Peak Ordering Hours

- Lunch: 12:00 PM – 1:00 PM
- Dinner: 5:00 PM – 7:00 PM, with top hours often at 6:00 PM and 7:00 PM
- Nearly half (48%) of all pizzas are made within these two timeframes.

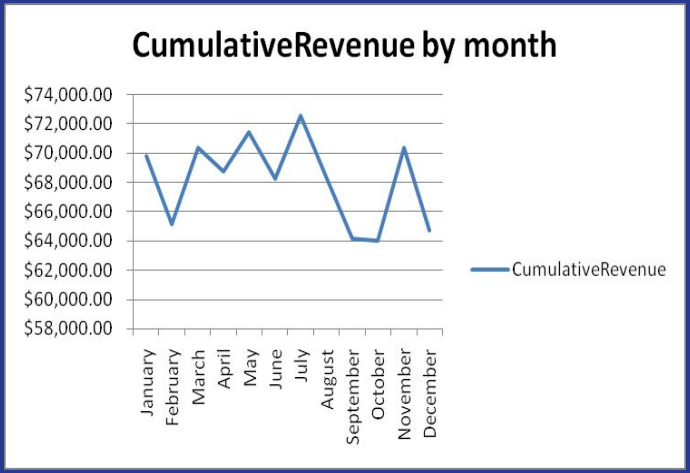


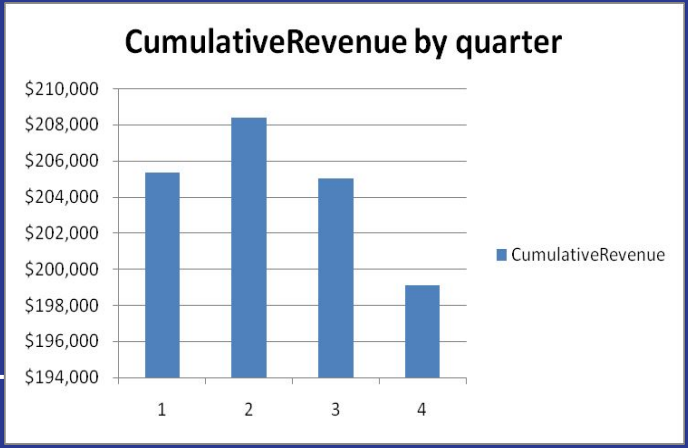
Average Pizzas Ordered Per Day

- The average number of customers is approximately 59–136 per day.
- Average orders can range from 100-300 per day for a standard pizzeria, while busier locations can exceed 500 on Fridays.
- The average order contains roughly 2.27 to 2.3 pizzas.

Variations by Time (Day, Month, Quarter)

- **Day of the Week:** Fridays and Saturdays are the busiest days, with high traffic often on Thursdays.
- **Month:** July is often a peak sales month.
- **Quarter:** Q2 has shown strong performance, while sales may experience a dip at the end of summer or Q4.





Cumulative Revenue Over Time

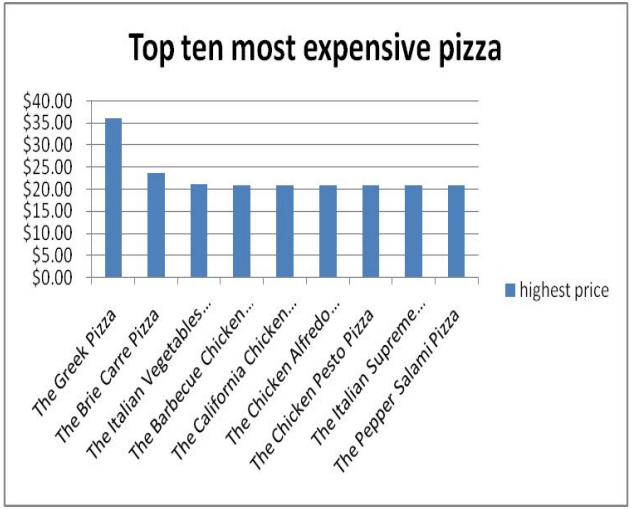
- **Total Revenue:** Analysis often shows a total yearly revenue around $817,860 for high-performing stores.
- **Trend:** There is a positive correlation between orders and revenue (more orders increase revenue).
- **Performance:** The highest sales tend to be in Q2, with monthly revenue peaking when order volume is highest.

Product Performance

Top 3 Pizzas per Category (by Sales/Revenue):

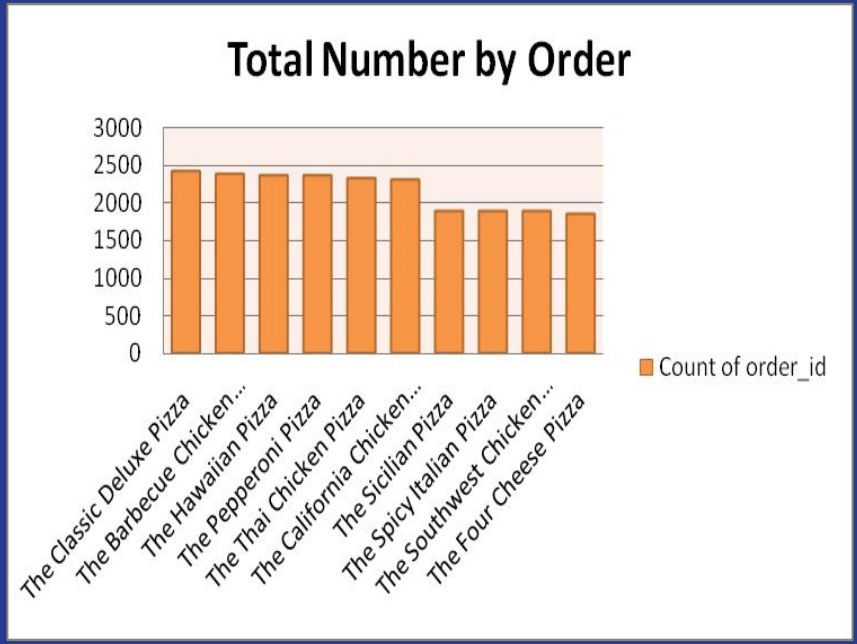
- **Classic:** The Classic Deluxe Pizza, The Hawaiian Pizza, and The Pepperoni Pizza.
- **Chicken:** The Thai Chicken Pizza, The Barbecue Chicken Pizza, and The California Chicken Pizza.
- **Supreme:** The Sicilian Pizza, The Spicy Italian Pizza, and The Southwest Chicken Pizza.
- **Veggie:** The Four Cheese Pizza, The Mexicana Pizza, and The Five Cheese Pizza.

- **Most Expensive Pizza:** The Greek Pizza (specifically the XL size) is the highest-priced item on the menu, costing $35.95.



Top 5 Best-Selling Pizzas (by Orders):

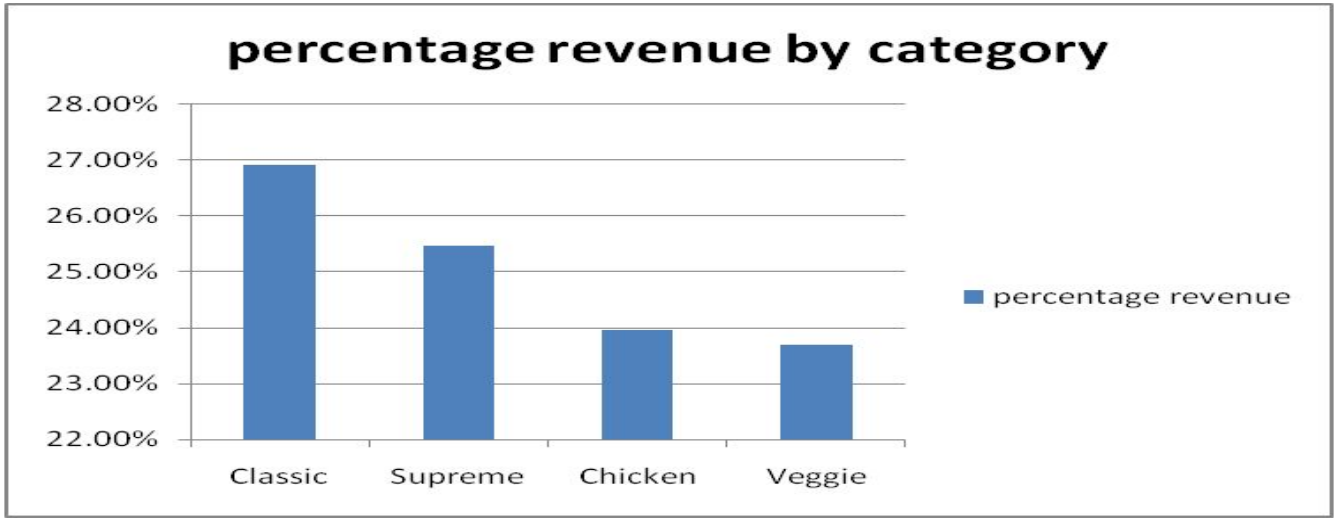
- The Classic Deluxe Pizza (approx. 2,329 orders).
- The Barbecue Chicken Pizza.
- The Hawaiian Pizza.
- The Pepperoni Pizza.
- The Thai Chicken Pizza



Percentage of Sales by Category and Size

By Category: Classic leads with ~26.9% of total revenue, followed by Supreme (~25.5%), Chicken (~23.96%), and Veggie (~23.6%).

By Size: Large (L) size dominates revenue at 45.9%, followed by Medium (M) at 30.5%, and Regular (S) at 21.8%. Extra-large sizes (XL and XXL) contribute less than 2% combined.



Recommendations

- **Optimize Staffing for Peak Hours:** Increase kitchen and delivery staff between 12PM – 1PM and 5PM – 8PM, especially on Fridays and Saturdays, to handle the surge in demand.
- **Promote "Bottom 5" Items:** Offer discounts or bundle deals (e.g., "Brie Carre" pizza) to clear inventory of lower-performing varieties.
- **Upsell Large Sizes:** Since Large pizzas drive nearly half of the revenue, create "Family Value Meals" that encourage customers to choose Large over Medium or Small.
- **Seasonal Campaigns:** Launch targeted marketing in July and January (peak months) to maximize existing high demand, while offering "Mid-week Specials" on Tuesdays to boost slower days.
- **Focus on Classic Category:** Since the Classic category is the top revenue driver, ensure these ingredients are always in stock and consider introducing "limited-time" variations of these popular flavors.

Thanks!

QUESTIONS?

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